VIT BHOPAL UNIVERSITY

Department of Bachelor of Technology
(Computer Science and Engineering)

DIGITAL LITERACY PORTFOLIO

Student Digital Ambassador Assignment

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COURSE DETAILS:
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1 Task 1: Digital Storytelling Presentation

Objective: To communicate the importance of digital literacy using modern visual tools.

- **Tool Used:** Canva / Prezi
- **Content:** A 5-slide deck titled "Navigating the Digital Campus."
- **Link:** [Insert your Canva Link here]
- **Description:** This presentation outlines the 3 pillars of digital safety: Privacy, Verification, and Respectful Communication.

2 Task 2: Professional Online Portfolio

Objective: Establishing a professional digital footprint.

- **Platforms:** LinkedIn and GitHub.
- **Key Updates:** Optimized Bio with "Student Digital Ambassador" title, added CSE Core skills, and uploaded a professional headshot.
- **Reflection:** Maintaining a professional profile ensures that my digital footprint aligns with my career goals as a CSE student.

3 Task 3: Digital Platform Engagement

Objective: Active and responsible participation in digital communities.

- **Activity:** Moderating a discussion on the college Discord server regarding AI ethics.
- **Observation:** Digital platforms require active "upstanding"—intervening when misinformation is spread and citing credible sources.

4 Task 4: Professional Email Etiquette

Objective: Mastering formal digital communication.

4.1 Email Draft: Requesting a Recommendation

Subject: Request for Recommendation Letter - Vedika Rajpali (25BCE11386)

Dear Professor [Name],
I hope this email finds you well. I am writing to respectfully request a letter of recommendation for my application to the [Program Name]. Having thoroughly enjoyed your CSE0001 module...

4.2 Etiquette Checklist

- Clear and concise subject lines.
- Professional salutations.
- Proofreading for tone and grammar.

5 Task 5: Cybercrime Case Study & Prevention

Case Study: Phishing Attacks in University Networks.
Overview: Analysis of how "Urgent Fee Payment" emails are used to steal student credentials.
Prevention Checklist:

1. Always check the sender's email domain (@vitbhopal.ac.in).
2. Never click on shortened URLs (bit.ly) from unknown sources.
3. Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) on all university accounts.

6 Reflection & Conclusion

Serving as a Digital Ambassador has highlighted the gap between "using technology" and "understanding technology." This portfolio documents my journey in bridging that gap for myself and my peers.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Visual Resource

For this task, I designed a one-page infographic using Canva. The design is tailored specifically for my batchmates at VIT Bhopal, aiming to simplify the broad concept of digital literacy into actionable steps. The visual resource is divided into three core segments: a modern definition of digital literacy, a curated list of essential tools like GitHub and Overleaf for CSE students, and a "Cyber-Safety" checklist to protect student identities online. I utilized a clean, tech-oriented color palette (VIT Blue and Slate Grey) to ensure the information is readable and professional.

One thing I found particularly interesting while creating this design was the challenge of "visual hierarchy." As a CSE student, I am used to technical documentation, but translating complex security concepts into simple, catchy icons required a different type of "design thinking." It was difficult to decide which tools to include, as the digital landscape is vast, but I prioritized tools that offer the most academic value. This process taught me that being a Digital Ambassador is as much about effective communication as it is about technical knowledge.

Task 2: Foundational Professional Portfolio

For this task, I established my professional digital presence across three key platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. LinkedIn serves as my primary professional network, where I connect with industry leaders and track internship opportunities. GitHub is my technical "living resume," allowing me to showcase my codebase and version control skills to potential recruiters. I chose Kaggle to explore data science datasets and participate in community competitions, which is essential for a CSE Core student.

Over the next four years at VIT Bhopal, I plan to use these platforms as a roadmap for my career. I will use LinkedIn to document my journey as a Student Digital Ambassador and GitHub to host every major academic project I undertake. Kaggle will serve as a continuous learning hub to sharpen my analytical skills. By maintaining these profiles early, I am building a "digital trail" of my growth, ensuring that by my final year, my online presence reflects a consistent and technically proficient engineering professional.

Task 3: Digital Platform Engagement

For the technical portion of this task, I utilized HackerRank to complete a Python foundational challenge. This platform is essential for CSE students as it provides a structured environment for competitive programming and interview preparation. By earning my first badge, I demonstrated the baseline technical literacy required to guide my peers in their coding journeys.

In the collaboration segment, I developed a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms and linked it to Google Sheets for automated data collection. This tool is vital for my role as an Ambassador, as it allows me to assess the "digital health" of my batch and identify common knowledge gaps in online safety. Academically, these tools will be indispensable; HackerRank will help me prepare for upcoming placement assessments, while Google Workspace will streamline group projects and research data management. Mastering these platforms ensures that I can maintain my own technical edge while providing organized, data-driven support to the student community at VIT Bhopal.

Task 4: Professional Communication and Ethics

A notable situation where poor digital communication caused significant issues involves a hypothetical "Group Project Conflict" on a public Discord server. In this scenario, a student publicly blamed a teammate for a failed submission using aggressive language. This unprofessional outburst not only damaged the team's relationship but was also seen by a faculty moderator, leading to a formal warning for the student.

To handle this differently, the student should have adhered to the "Private Resolution" rule. They could have sent a professional, private message outlining the specific technical issues and suggested a meeting to resolve the bottleneck. This approach maintains professional integrity and follows the "Netiquette" standards expected of a VIT Bhopal student. Effective digital communication is not just about grammar; it is about choosing the right channel and tone for the situation.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness and Prevention

While researching UPI fraud, what surprised me most was the psychological sophistication of "social engineering." It is rarely a technical hack; instead, it is a manipulation of trust and urgency. I was shocked to learn how many students fall for QR code scams simply because they do not realize that a PIN is never required to receive funds.

As a result of this research, one habit I will personally change is my "click-reflex." I have committed to the "5-second rule"—pausing for five seconds to manually inspect the sender's email address or the UPI ID before interacting with any digital request. This small change in behavior is the most effective firewall against modern cyber threats, and I intend to model this habit for my peers as their Digital Ambassador.